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Senior Software Engineer (Full Stack)

Office for National Statistics

Apply before 11:55 pm on Tuesday 10th November 2026

Reference number

487556

Salary

£44,050 - £47,121

National (£44,050 - £47,121). Plus a skills allowance of up to £5,000 (non-pensionable and non-contractual) may be payable. Starting salary and level of skills allowance will depend on a technical skills assessment at interview.

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Senior Executive Officer

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

ONS - Digital and Technology - Digital Services (DS)

Type of role

Digital
Information Technology

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time, Compressed hours

Number of jobs available

4

Contents

Location
About the job
Benefits
Things you need to know
Apply and further information

Location

The locations for this role are Newport and Titchfield (Fareham).

Due to workforce controls you can only select Manchester / London / Darlington / Edinburgh / Belfast if you are an existing ONS employee contracted to that location. If you are not contracted at one of these sites,

these options are not available to you.

Only existing ONS contractual homeworkers can select Homeworking.

Applicants who select a location they are not eligible for will be removed from the recruitment process and will not be considered for alternative locations. Please refer to attachments for further terms and flexibilities.

The induction process for the role will be conducted in person.

About the job

Job summary

Are you an accomplished Software Engineer looking for a role where you can make a real impact, using your technical experience to enable us to deliver our Statistics for the Public Good strategy for the UK?

We are looking for experienced Software Engineers to join us! We are looking for forward-thinking people with a passion for Continuous Integration and Continuous Delivery working on the latest cloud and software applications. You will have an eye for detail and stakeholder management skills to provide technical and procedural expertise working within our Digital Services (DS) Directorate.

About Digital Services
Our digital teams develop, deliver and support a broad range of products and services that are central to the work of the Office for National Statistics (ONS). These services span the statistical lifecycle, supporting how data is collected, processed, managed and made available to users.
We work closely with business areas, users and technical teams to develop new capabilities, enhance existing services and ensure established products continue to meet changing needs. Our teams use a broad range of technologies and collaborate with colleagues and external suppliers to deliver secure, reliable and user-focused digital services.

Job description

About the opportunities

We are recruiting for two roles across two areas of digital delivery. Although each role will have a different focus, both provide the opportunity to work within multidisciplinary teams, collaborate across ONS and contribute to the delivery and continuous improvement of important digital services.

The technologies listed are examples rather than a definitive list, and we welcome applications from candidates with experience using other relevant or comparable technologies.

Role 1: Digital Applications Survey Data Collection (SDC)

This role will sit within Digital Applications, working in our Survey Data Collection (SDC) area. SDC provides digital products and services that support the collection of survey data across ONS, from designing and completing online questionnaires to setting up surveys, managing respondent interactions and moving survey data and metadata between systems.

The role will primarily focus on **Respondent Account Services (RASRM)**, a key part of the Survey Data Collection (SDC) landscape. RASRM provides services that support how respondents interact with ONS surveys, including respondent accounts, secure messaging and survey management capabilities.

Alongside your core focus on respondent services, you will work collaboratively across the wider Survey Data Collection area, contributing to the services that support the end-to-end delivery and collection of ONS surveys.

You will work as part of a multidisciplinary team to develop and improve these services, balancing the delivery of new capability with the security, resilience and maintenance of live services. The work may include improving experiences for respondents and ONS users, modernising technology and helping reduce reliance on legacy systems.

Technology:

Java / Spring Boot Python / Flask Go GCP GKE / Kubernetes Docker Helm Terraform Cloud SQL Pub/Sub GitHub Actions / Concourse Cloud Build / Cloud Deploy

Role 2: Dissemination

Dissemination provides and supports the digital services used to publish official statistics through the ONS website and application programming interfaces (APIs). The area runs live publishing services while transforming the technology that supports the ONS website, including a new content management system, dataset services, shared applications, and cloud-based infrastructure.

This work is central to making ONS statistics available, accessible, and reliable for the public, government, researchers, and other users. The role is in a team which develops, supports and improves services used across the current and new ONS website platforms. Its responsibilities include search, authentication, routing, and feedback services, alongside components that support content migration and the transition from legacy technology.
You will work closely with other software engineering teams, product and delivery colleagues, publishing and technical specialists. The team supports live services and contributes to the wider transformation of the ONS website, so engineers work across new development, integration, operational support, and the improvement of existing services.

Technology:

Java Go Python MongoDB API-based and microservice architectures CI/CD pipelines Apache Kafka AWS HTML/Jinja templating

Responsibilities:

The roles will include:

- Develop and enhance software solutions to meet user story needs.
- Follow best practice guidelines and help to improve those guidelines.
- Write clean, secure, and well-tested code.
- Coach and mentor colleagues.
- Support a continuous delivery environment, using effective delivery and deployment techniques
- Operate the services they build and identify issues in production.
- Design and execute a range of test techniques.

Person specification

Essential Skills Criteria

Programming and build (software engineering) (Practitioner)
Collaborates with others when necessary to review specifications. Uses these agreed specifications to design, code, test and document programs or scripts of medium to high complexity, using the right standards and tools. Contributes to code reviews and gives constructive feedback to others.

Systems Design (Practitioner) - Designs systems characterised by medium levels of risk, impact and business or technical complexity. Selects appropriate design standards, methods and tools and ensures they are applied effectively. Reviews the systems designs of others to ensure selection of appropriate technology, efficient use of resources and integration of multiple systems and technology.

Test Engineering (Practitioner) Able to design, implement and execute functional and non-functional tests using a wide range of techniques and frameworks. Able to make decisions on running types of test cases, and environments for testing. Able to work with the team to develop and iterate on testing standards. Maintains and adapts CI/CD pipelines to ensure effective test integration and quality gates. Able to guide and coach others in creating and maintaining comprehensive and reliable tests that meet standards. Able to research and prepare for future testing needs, including tools, methodologies and techniques.

Modern Developments Standards (Practitioner) Able to apply modern development standards and support others in applying them. Contributes to continuous improvement of approaches.

Service Support (Practitioner) - Identifies, locates and fixes service faults in production and non-production environments. Investigates and resolves complex or undocumented issues, using a variety of methods, tools and system knowledge. (Such as logs, test results etc). Triage incidents, assesses impact and priority, and create stories or tasks for fixes. Contributes to team support practices by documenting resolutions, improving processes and supporting colleagues in diagnosing issues.

You may have deeper expertise in some areas than others, but you must demonstrate a willingness to learn and develop across the full technical stack. Experience working collaboratively in agile teams and delivering reliable, production-grade services is essential.

We expect that you will have experience of using these technologies, accepting that experience of some might be more limited but you must be keen to learn all the technical stack above. Please ensure that your CV fully reflects those that you have used before. Your desire to learn and develop in a collaborative software environment will also be what we are looking for.

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Changing and Improving

Managing a Quality Service

Delivering at Pace

Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

Programming and Build (Practitioner)

Test Engineering (Practitioner)

Service Support (Practitioner)

Communication between technical and non technical (Practitioner)

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £44,050, Office for National Statistics contributes £12,761 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides (opens in a new window).

The Office for National Statistics is part of the Civil Service, and as such we share a number of key benefits with other departments, whilst also having our own unique offerings to support our valued colleagues across the organisation.

Whether you are hearing about us for the first time or already know a bit about our organisation, we hope that our careers site will give you a great insight into the benefits and facilities available to our colleagues, and our fantastic working culture.

Inclusion & Diversity

Inclusion & Accessibility

At ONS we are always looking to attract the very best people from the widest possible talent pool, and we are proud to be an inclusive, equal opportunities employer. As a Disability Confident Leader we re committed to ensuring that all candidates are treated fairly throughout the recruitment process.

As part of our application process, you will be prompted to provide details of any reasonable adjustments to our recruitment process that you need. If you would like to discuss any reasonable adjustments before applying, please contact the recruitment team in the first instance.

If you would like an accessible version of any of the attachments or recruitment documents below or linked to in this advert, please contact the recruitment team who will be happy to assist.

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance (opens in a new window) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using Success Profiles (opens in a new window), and will assess your Behaviours, Experience and Technical skills.

Security Clearance

For ONS the requirement for SC clearance is to have been present in the UK for 3 consecutive years immediately prior to applying and the department will consider eligibility by exception on a case-by-case basis. You will be asked to provide information regarding your UK residency during your application, and failure to provide this will result in your application being rejected.

If you are unsure that you meet the eligibility above, please read the information available on Gov.uk on this link, or contact the recruitment email on the advert before applying to discuss, as failure to meet the residency requirements will result in your security clearance application being rejected and any offer of employment being withdrawn.

At the point of SC application, you will need to provide or give access to the following evidence:

- **Departmental or company records (personnel files, staff reports, sick leave reports and security records)**
- **UK criminal records covering both spent and unspent criminal records**
- **Your credit and financial history with a credit reference agency**
- **Security Services records**

ONS are unable to offer visa sponsorship for this role. Applicants are expected to hold a valid right to work in the UK when employment commences. If you are applying on a time-limited visa, this will need to be valid for at least 18 months at point of application.

To work at the ONS, candidates must meet both UK right to work and security clearance requirements (where applicable).

If you are unsure whether you meet the appropriate right to work or security clearance eligibility criteria, please refer to the guidance on Gov.uk or contact the recruitment email provided in the advert **before applying**. Failure to meet these requirements will result in your application being rejected and employment offers being withdrawn.

For full guidance in relation to the use of AI through the recruitment process, please read A candidate s guide to artificial intelligence (AI) in recruitment

Please note that all campaigns may be subject to withdrawal at any stage if the internal resource position changes.

Application Process

Number of Stages: 2 stage process

Stage 1: Application

Stage 2: Interview

Stage 1 Application

The assessment process at the application stage will be based on your work history, skills, experience, CV, and personal statement. It is important that your application is tailored to highlight the skills, knowledge, and experience relevant to the role.

A personal statement is required at application stage, the maximum wordcount allowed is 1250 words, which should not be exceeded. You should provide evidence for each essential skill criterion listed in the person specification. As these criteria are scored, it is advisable to give clear examples for each one, including the impact of your actions, ideally utilising the STAR technique (Situation, Task, Action, Result).

Please note that Success Profiles Behaviour examples are not required at this stage of the application process.

When a high volume of applications are received, the sift pass mark may be adjusted. Candidates will be invited to interview based on their merit order, with those achieving the highest scores being prioritised. Applicants who score below the adjusted pass mark but still pass will be placed on hold and may be invited to interview at a later date.

Stage 2 Interview

If invited to interview, you will be assessed using techniques aligned with the Civil Service Success Profiles framework, covering all behaviours listed in the job advert and any required technical skills.

A presentation against the behaviour "Managing a Quality Service" will be required at interview.

Interviews may be in person or via Microsoft Teams.

A reserve list may be held for a period up to 12 months from which further appointments may be made.

The Sift will be conducted from 19/11/2026

Interviews will be conducted from 30/11/2026

For the full terms and conditions of the post, please see attachment.

Near Misses

We often have similar roles available at different grades. If a candidate is suitable for a similar role or a lower grade than they have applied for, we may offer the candidate that role without the need to go through a further selection process providing the role has the same behaviours and essential skills.

GDD Pay

This role is eligible for the **Government Digital and Data (GDD) Capability and Pay Framework**. If you are successful at interview, your **salary will be directly linked to your capability outcome**, as determined by your performance in the **Technical section** of the interview.

- **Capability Outcome**: Assessed based on scores achieved during the technical interview.
- **Salary Determination**: Your starting salary will reflect the capability level assigned.
- **Feedback**: Full feedback on your capability outcome will be provided at the **point of offer**.

All successful candidates are required to undertake an **annual capability assessment** as part of their ongoing employment terms. The outcome of this assessment directly influences individual pay levels:

- **Higher Capability Outcome**: Results in an **increase in pay**.

Lower Capability Outcome: Results in a **decrease in pay**.

Completion of the assessment is **mandatory**. Failure to complete the annual capability assessment will result in the individual being transitioned to **ONS pay terms and conditions**, with a corresponding **adjustment to their pay**.

If you're already in a GDD Group 1 role and receiving GDD pay, and you make a lateral move (i.e. same grade, different role):

Initial Capability Assessment:

Development Plan:

Reassessment at 6 Months:

Starting salary for roles within the **Government Digital and Data (GDD) Capability and Pay Framework** is determined **solely by the capability outcome** achieved during the recruitment process.

Please note:

Existing allowances (scarce skills) will **not be taken into account** when calculating starting salary.

This policy applies to **all candidates**, including **existing Civil Servants** and **ONS colleagues** transitioning to the GDD Capability and Pay Framework.

Curious about Government Digital and Data? Dive into the Candidate Pack to learn more

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is security check (opens in a new window).

See our vetting charter (opens in a new window).

People working with government assets must complete baseline personnel security standard (opens in new window) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals
- nationals of the Republic of Ireland
- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS) (opens in a new window)
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)
- individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020
- Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

Further information on nationality requirements (opens in a new window)

Working for the Civil Service

The Civil Service Code (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's recruitment principles (opens in a new window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan (opens in a new window) and the Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy (opens in a new window).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the Great Place to Work for Veterans (opens in a new window) initiative.

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name :	Government Digital and Data Recruitment Team
Email :	Government-Digital-and-Data-Recruitment@ons.gov.uk
Recruitment team	
Email :	About.You@ons.gov.uk

Further information

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, in the first instance, you should contact recruitment.complaints@ons.gov.uk. If you are not satisfied with the response you receive from the Department, you can contact the Civil Service Commission here

Civil Service Commission

disability confident LEADER